

CANDIDATE CARD NO. 2

MEDICINE

SETTING

Local Clinic

DOCTOR

You see the parent of a five-year-old boy who was diagnosed with asthma a couple of days ago, after attending the Emergency Department with a severe bout of coughing, breathing difficulty and wheezing. This is a follow-up appointment. The child is not present for the discussion.

TASK

- Confirm reason for appointment (follow-up following asthma diagnosis). Find out how child has been since hospital visit (severity of asthma, frequency of attacks, effect of treatment, etc.).
- Find out further relevant details (any family history of: asthma, eczema, hay fever, etc.). Explore possible triggers of child's asthma attacks (exposure to: cigarette smoke, dust mites, pollen; exercise; cold air; etc.).
- Give information about childhood asthma (chronic lung condition: tightening or narrowing of muscles in airways, swelling/inflammation, production of extra mucus; risk factors: family history of hay fever; etc.). Find out any concerns.
- Reassure parent about child's asthma (e.g., manageable, regular monitoring, support available, etc.). Describe asthma management (e.g., identifying and controlling triggers, assessing severity of symptoms, knowing how to respond in urgent situation, informing child's school, etc.).
- Outline next steps (e.g., examination of child, creation of asthma action plan, discussion of treatment, organising: support, follow-up appointments, etc.). Establish parent's willingness to bring child into room for examination.